SKELITE TALENT PARTNERS

HRBP Pack

11 assets · Rs 599

Sample pages. The pages that follow are taken unedited from the pack you receive.

WHAT YOU GET

- 11 files: 8 Word documents, 3 working Excel tools
- Restructuring playbook with the Industrial Relations Code thresholds
- Headcount model that counts WORKERS, not payroll headcount
- Span of control analyser that shows where the structure is wrong
- Competency framework builder and capability gap tracker

WRITTEN AGAINST THE LAW AS IT STANDS

The four Labour Codes commenced 21 November 2025. Central rules followed in May 2026. Every document states the position it was written against.

SKELITE TALENT PARTNERS

Start Here — Pack Guide

Pack 11 — HR Business Partner | Ref: P11-00

The strategic layer. For when HR stops processing and starts shaping the business.

WHAT THIS PACK DOES

Every other pack in this toolkit answers a process question. This one answers a judgement question: how should this organisation be shaped, staffed and changed.

It is written for the person who sits between the founder and the organisation. That might be a dedicated HRBP, or it might be you doing the HRBP job alongside everything else. Either way, the output is the same: decisions about structure and headcount that can be explained and defended.

THE DISTINCTION THIS PACK IS BUILT ON

Almost every statutory threshold in Indian labour law counts WORKERS, not employees.

Under section 2(zr) of the Industrial Relations Code 2020, a "worker" excludes anyone employed in a managerial or administrative capacity, and excludes supervisory staff drawing wages above Rs 18,000 a month. That threshold was raised from Rs 10,000 and can be revised by notification, so verify the current figure before you rely on it.

This matters more than it sounds. A company with 320 people on the payroll may have well under 300 workers once managers, administrative staff and higher-paid supervisors come out. A workforce plan built on total headcount will misread every threshold it touches, in both directions. The headcount model in P11-08 counts both figures side by side for exactly this reason.

WHAT IS INSIDE

Ref	Asset	Format	What it is for
P11-00	**Start Here — Pack Guide**	Word	This document.
P11-01	**HRBP Operating Model & Charter**	Word	What the role does, what it does not, and how it is measured.
P11-02	**Organisation Design Guide**	Word	Structures, spans, layers, and when to change them.
P11-03	**Workforce Planning Guide**	Word	Demand, supply, gap. Build, buy or borrow.
P11-04	**Competency Framework Builder**	Word	Levels, behaviours, and how to write one that gets used.
P11-05	**Restructuring & Change Playbook**	Word	The IR Code thresholds, the process, and the communication.
P11-06	**Business Partnering Toolkit**	Word	Stakeholder mapping, the quarterly business review, influencing without authority.
P11-07	**People Diagnostic**	Word	A structured read of where the organisation actually hurts.
P11-08	**Workforce Plan & Headcount Model**	Excel	Demand, attrition, cost, and the worker-count threshold

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SKELITE TALENT PARTNERS

Restructuring and Change Management Playbook

Pack 11 — HR Business Partner | Ref: P11-05

The thresholds, the sequence, and an honest line on where you need counsel.

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

Field	Detail
Purpose	To plan and run an organisational change that affects roles, lawfully and without destroying trust.
When to use it	Before any change that removes, merges or materially alters roles.
Who should use it	Founder and HRBP, with employment counsel engaged from the start where roles go.
Output	A planned, documented, advised change process.
Time to complete	Weeks, not days. Treat any plan shorter than that as a warning sign.

Step-by-step instructions

1. **Count your workers —** Section 2. Not your headcount.
2. **Establish which tier you are in —** Section 3.
3. **Get advice if roles are going —** Section 4. This is not optional at scale.
4. **Plan the sequence —** Section 5.
5. **Select fairly and record why —** Section 6.
6. **Communicate properly —** Section 7.
7. **Support the people who remain —** Section 9. Routinely forgotten.

1. SCOPE OF THIS DOCUMENT

This playbook covers collective change: restructures, role removals, team mergers, site changes. It does not cover individual performance exits, which are in Pack 03, or disciplinary dismissals, which are in Pack 05.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS NOT

This is not a do-it-yourself retrenchment manual, and it is not legal advice. It gives you the thresholds, the sequence and the questions so that you arrive at a lawyer's office prepared rather than panicking, and so that you know when you need one.

Collective retrenchment carried out badly in India is expensive, slow to unwind and difficult to defend. If roles are being removed, engage employment counsel at the planning stage, not after the announcement.

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- **Any time you are at or near 300 workers.** Near counts. Crossing the line mid-process is worse than starting above it.
- **Any union or works committee presence.** Consultation obligations are different and wider.
- **Any multi-state operation.** Thresholds and procedures vary by state.
- **Any change to terms or conditions of service.** Imposing material change may require notice under the Code.
- **Any closure of a unit or site.** Closure has its own requirements.

5. SEQUENCE

The order matters. Doing step six before step four is how organisations end up unwinding an announcement.

1. **Establish the business case —** Written, with the actual reason. If it is cost, say cost.
2. **Count workers and fix the tier —** Sections 2 and 3.
3. **Engage counsel —** Section 4.
4. **Design the future structure —** P11-02. Design the shape before you look at the names.
5. **Map people to the new structure —** Who continues, who changes, who has no role.
6. **Test alternatives to removal —** Section 8. Do this genuinely, and record it.
7. **Obtain permission if required —** 300 or more workers. Before anything else happens.
8. **Select, using recorded criteria —** Section 6.
9. **Consult —** Properly. Not an announcement with a question mark on the end.
10. **Notify and pay what is owed —** Notice or wages in lieu, retrenchment compensation, dues.
11. **Communicate to everyone —** Section 7.
12. **Support the people who remain —** Section 9.

6. SELECTION

Where you must choose between people doing similar work, the criteria must be set before you look at the names, applied consistently, and recorded.

- **Know the last-in-first-out principle.** Indian law has historically expected the most recently employed worker in a category to go first, with departures from that order requiring recorded reasons. Take advice on how it applies to your situation before you select on any other basis.
- **If you depart from it, record why.** In writing, at the time, not reconstructed afterwards.
- **Keep criteria objective and job-related.** Skills the future structure needs, demonstrated performance on record, qualifications relevant to the role.
- **Never select on these.** Gender, pregnancy or maternity, caring responsibilities, health or disability, age, religion, caste, union membership, or having raised a grievance or a POSH complaint. Any of these converts a restructure into something far more serious.
- **Score everyone in the pool on the same sheet.** A selection you cannot show the working for is a selection you cannot defend.

TWO PROTECTIONS TO CHECK BEFORE YOU FINALISE ANY LIST

Anyone on maternity leave or within the protected period has specific protections. Anyone who has raised a POSH complaint or a grievance is exposed to a victimisation argument if they appear on a redundancy list, however coincidental it is. Neither makes selection impossible, but both need legal advice before the list is final.

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